Finding 2 - Make Events and Find Them (Sysmon)

Objective

Perform simple actions on the Windows VM and find the matching Sysmon events in Event Viewer.

Location: Applications and Services Logs > Microsoft > Windows > Sysmon > Operational

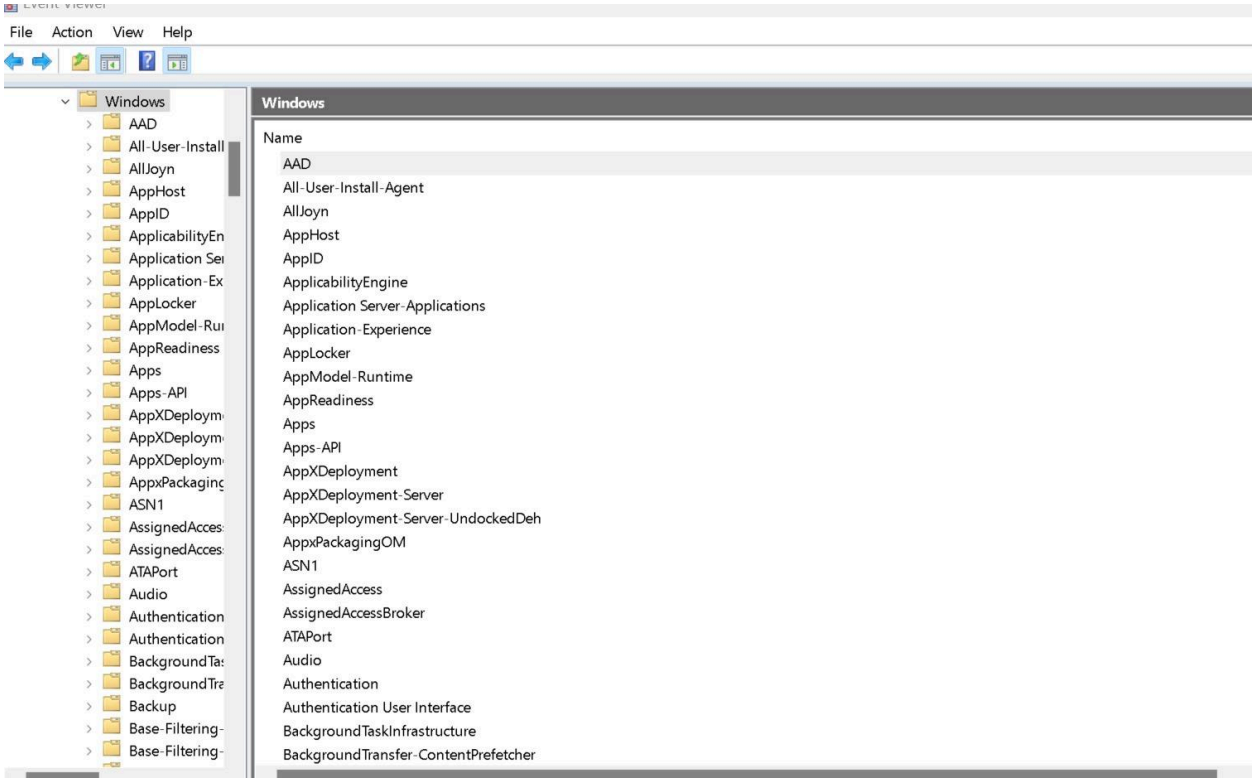
Summary table

#	Action performed	Sysmon Event ID	Event name
1	Opened PowerShell	1	Process Create
2	Created a new user account	1	Process Create (`net.exe` / `net1.exe`)
3	Checked network connections	3	Network Connection
4	Created a text file	11	File Create

Event 1 - Open PowerShell (Event ID 1: Process Create)

Action: Opened Windows PowerShell from the Start menu.

Item	Detail
Event ID	1
Timestamp	As shown in Screenshot 2.1 (UtcTime field)
Image	`C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe`
CommandLine	`"C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe"`
User	The logged-in user shown in Screenshot 2.1
ParentImage	`C:\Windows\explorer.exe`



Why it matters to a SOC analyst: PowerShell is the most abused built-in tool for attackers (execution, download, obfuscation). Event ID 1 records who started it, from which parent process and with which arguments. PowerShell launched by Office applications, with encoded commands (`-enc`), or from unusual parents is a strong indicator of compromise (T1059.001).

Event 2 - Create a new user account (Event ID 1: Process Create)

Action: Created a local user from an elevated Command Prompt with `net user <username> <password> /add`.

Item	Detail
Event ID	1
Timestamp	As shown in Screenshot 2.2
Image	`C:\Windows\System32\net.exe` (and a child event for `net1.exe`)
CommandLine	`net user <username> <password> /add` (exact text visible in Screenshot 2.2)
User	The administrator account used, shown in Screenshot 2.2

Item	Detail
ParentImage	`C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe`

Why it matters to a SOC analyst: Creating accounts is a common persistence technique (T1136.001). Sysmon shows the exact command line used, including the account name, which the Windows Security log alone (Event 4720) does not show in the same way. Analysts compare this with Security Event 4720 to confirm the account creation and identify who did it.

Event 3 - Check network connections (Event ID 3: Network Connection)

Action: Generated and viewed network activity (for example `netstat -an` and browsing / `ping` / `curl` to a website) so that processes made outbound connections.

Item	Detail
Event ID	3
Timestamp	As shown in Screenshot 2.3
Image	Process that made the connection (as shown in Screenshot 2.3)
User	As shown in Screenshot 2.3
SourceIp / SourcePort	Local VM address and port, as shown in Screenshot 2.3
DestinationIp / DestinationPort	Remote address and port, as shown in Screenshot 2.3
Protocol	tcp

Why it matters to a SOC analyst: Event ID 3 ties a network connection to the exact process and user that made it. This is essential for detecting command-and-control traffic, lateral movement and data exfiltration (for example, `powershell.exe` or `notepad.exe` connecting to an unknown external IP).

Event 4 - Create a text file (Event ID 11: File Create)

Action: Created a new text file (for example `test.txt`) on the Desktop.

Item	Detail
Event ID	11
Timestamp	As shown in Screenshot 2.4

Item	Detail
Image	Process that created the file (for example `explorer.exe` or `notepad.exe`)
TargetFilename	Full path of the new file, as shown in Screenshot 2.4
User	As shown in Screenshot 2.4

Why it matters to a SOC analyst: File creation events reveal dropped malware, staging files, ransomware notes and scripts written to unusual folders (Temp, Public, Startup). The `Image` and `TargetFilename` fields show which process wrote which file.

Conclusion

Event ID	Value for analysts
1	Who ran what, with which command line and from which parent
3	Which process talked to which IP and port
11	Which process created which file and where

Together these events let an analyst reconstruct an attack chain: execution, account creation, network activity and file drops.